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Personnel

AIR RESERVE FORCES POLICY COMMITTEE AND MAJOR COMMAND AIR RESERVE COMPONENTS POLICY AND ADVISORY COUNCILS

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This instruction implements Department of the Air Force Policy Directive 36-26, *Total Force Development and Management*, and is consistent with Title 10 United States Code (U.S.C.) Section (§) 10305, *Air Force Reserve Forces Policy Committee (ARFPC)*. It provides guidance on the operating procedures of the Air Reserve Forces Policy Committee and its policy subcommittees for the Air National Guard (ANG) and the Air Force Reserve (AFR) as delegated by the Assistant Secretary of the Air Force, Manpower and Reserve Affairs (SAF/MR) in accordance with Headquarters Air Force Mission Directive 1-1, *Headquarters Department of the Air Force (HQ DAF)*, and Headquarters Mission Directive 1-24, *Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Manpower and Reserve Affairs)*. This publication applies to all uniformed members of the Regular Air Force (RegAF), the Air Force Reserve (AFR), the Air National Guard (ANG), the United States Space Force, all Department of the Air Force (DAF) civilian employees, and those with a contractual obligation to abide by the terms of DAF issuances. The term "Reserve Components" applies to both the AFR and ANG throughout this publication. This Department of the Air Force publication may be supplemented at any level. Refer recommended changes and questions regarding this publication to the office of primary responsibility using the DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*; route DAF Form 847s from the field through the appropriate functional chain of command. Ensure all records generated because of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, located in the Air Force Records Information Management System. This instruction contains Tier 0 compliance statements where applicable (i.e., waiver authority external

to the DAF). For non-tiered compliance items, submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the publication office of primary responsibility. See Department of the Air Force Manual (DAFMAN) 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, for additional information on waiver processes.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document has been substantially revised and must be completely reviewed. These changes include removal of Director of Enterprise Information Technology (SAF/CNS) as a non-voting advisor, the addition of Director of Personnel (HAF/REP); Director of Plans and Integration (HAF/A1X); Director of Force Management Policy (NGB/A1); and Air Force Reserve Command Director of Manpower, Personnel, and Services (AFRC/A1) positions as non-voting advisors. Additionally, changes reflect new office and position designations due to SAF/MR re-organization.

Chapter 1—ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES **4**

1.1. Role of the Air Reserve Forces Policy Committee (ARFPC). 4

1.2. Responsibilities. 4

Chapter 2—ARFPC MEMBERS AND OTHER PARTICIPANTS **6**

2.1. Primary Members. 6

2.2. Alternate Members. 6

2.3. Chair and Vice Chair. 7

2.4. Non-voting Advisors. 7

2.5. Designated Representatives. 8

2.6. Designated Guests. 8

2.7. ARFPC Full-Time Support Staff. 8

2.8. ARFPC Delegate Support Staff. 8

Chapter 3—ARFPC PROCEDURES **10**

3.1. Full Conference Forum. 10

3.2. Closed Executive Session. 10

3.3. Subcommittee Meetings. 10

3.4. Voting. 11

3.5. Committee Reports. 11

3.6. Committee Meeting Minutes. 11

Chapter 4—MAJOR COMMAND RESERVE COMPONENT POLICY AND ADVISORY COUNCILS **12**

4.1. Establishing Reserve Component Policy and Advisory Councils. 12

4.2. Feedback to AFRPC. 12
4.3. Format and Function. 12
4.4. ARFPC Executive Director Interaction. 12
4.5. ARFPC Full Conference Forum. 12

Chapter 5—HEADQUARTERS AIR FORCE RESERVE COMPONENT ADVISORS AND ANG AND AFR FUNCTIONAL DIRECTORS 13

5.1. Link Between the ARFPC and Ongoing Air Force Policy Development. 13
5.2. ARFPC Executive Director Interaction. 13
5.3. ARFPC Full Conference Forum. 13

Attachment 1—GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION 14

Chapter 1

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

1.1. Role of the Air Reserve Forces Policy Committee (ARFPC). Title 10 U.S.C. § 10305, *Air Force Reserve Forces Policy Committee (ARFPC),* establishes the ARFPC including the Subcommittee on ANG Policy and the Subcommittee on AFR Policy. The ARFPC provides the Secretary of the Air Force (SecAF) and the Chief of Staff of the Air Force (CSAF) with unfiltered, objective, and independent advice on major policy matters affecting the Air Reserve Components and the mobilization preparedness of the Department of the Air Force. As a named component of the Office of the Secretary of the Air Force, operating under the administrative support of the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Warfighter Force Management and Readiness (SAF/MRW), the ARFPC ensures the SecAF and CSAF have direct access to Reserve Component senior leader perspectives and the pulse of Reserve Component Airmen.

1.2. Responsibilities.

1.2.1. **Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Manpower and Reserve Affairs (SAF/MR).** Advises the SecAF on committee membership and procedures and coordinates post-meeting reports from the ARFPC Chair to the SecAF and CSAF.

1.2.2. **Deputy Assistant Secretary, Warfighter Force Management and Readiness (SAF/MRW).** Provides administrative support to the ARFPC and serves as the SecAF's direct representative and nonvoting advisor, offering insight on current Department of the Air Force senior leader topics. Also oversees the ARFPC support staff.

1.2.3. **The Director of the Air National Guard (NGB/CF) and Chief of Air Force Reserve (AF/RE).**

1.2.3.1. Submit nominations for ARFPC vacancies for the air reserve component to SAF/MR through SAF/MRW, ARFPC Full-time Support Staff (see **paragraph 2.7**) using the DAF Enterprise Task Management Software Solution (ETMS2) or other coordinated process.

1.2.3.2. Selects and appoints ARFPC delegates from their components to serve on the ARFPC support staff. Each component will appoint, at a minimum, one officer (O-3 to O-5) and one noncommissioned officer (E-5 to E-8).

1.2.3.3. Refers policy issues to the ARFPC through the Executive Director or the Chair/Vice Chair.

1.2.4. **Major Command and Direct Reporting Unit Commanders or Equivalent (Field Operating Agency where applicable).**

1.2.4.1. Establishes Reserve Component Policy and Advisory Councils to consider policy matters, which directly affect reserve components.

1.2.4.2. Refers policy issues to the ARFPC through their reserve component advisors.

1.2.5. **Headquarters Air Force, Directorate of Total Force Integration (HAF/DSKI).** Selects and appoints an ARFPC Liaison Officer (grades O-3 to O-5) to support ARFPC meetings.

1.2.6. **Air Force General Counsel (SAF/GC) and The Judge Advocate General (AF/JA).** Each shall designate a legal advisor to support all ARFPC meetings.

Chapter 2

ARFPC MEMBERS AND OTHER PARTICIPANTS

2.1. Primary Members. The ARFPC is comprised of five officers, each from the Regular Air Force, ANG, and AFR in the grade of brigadier general and above. **(T-1)** SAF/MR appoints these officers pursuant to delegation by the SecAF.

2.1.1. **Regular Air Force Members.** SAF/MR appoints the following five HAF directors as Regular Air Force primary ARFPC members: Director of Military Force Management Policy (AF/A1P); Director, ISR Operations (AF/A2); Director of Logistics (AF/A4L); Director of Training and Readiness (AF/A34); and Director of Strategic Plans (AF/A8X).

2.1.1.1. Regular Air Force primary membership on the Committee is maintained for the duration of member's tenure in their Headquarters Air Force position.

2.1.1.2. Reserve component officers appointed to the ARFPC while serving in a Regular Air Force position may not act in the capacity of a Regular Air Force member. They may participate in ARFPC activities; however, a designated Regular Air Force alternate will cast any required votes on behalf of the Regular Air Force.

2.1.2. **Reserve Component (ANG and AFR) Members.** SAF/MR appoints five general officers each from the ANG and AFR to serve as primary ARFPC members.

2.1.2.1. NGB/CF and AF/RE submit nominations for ARFPC vacancies for the air reserve component to SAF/MR through the ARFPC Full-time Support Staff in SAF/MRW (see **paragraph 2.7**) using the DAF Enterprise Task Management Software Solution (ETMS2) or other coordinated process. NGB/A1 Director will be one of the five ANG nominees so long as the Director holds the grade of O-6 or higher at the time of the appointment. AF/REP Director will be one of the five AFR nominees so long as the Director holds the grade of O-6 or higher at the time of appointment.

2.1.2.2. Reserve component primary members are appointed for a three-year term. **(T-0)**

2.1.2.2.1. The ARFPC Chair can extend membership to no more than six months as needed.

2.2. Alternate Members. SAF/MR, under SecAF delegation, appoints nine alternates—three per component—each at brigadier general or above, ensuring scheduling flexibility and a quorum is available at every ARFPC meeting.

2.2.1. **Regular Air Force Alternates.** SAF/MR appoints the following Headquarters Air Force directors as Regular Air Force alternate members of the ARFPC: Director of Strategy, Concepts, and Assessments (AF/A5S), Director of Plans and Integration (AF/A1X), and Director of Security Forces (AF/A4S).

2.2.1.1. Regular Air Force alternate membership on the committee is maintained for the duration of member's tenure in their Headquarters Air Force position.

2.2.2. **ANG and AFR Alternates.** SAF/MR appoints three ANG and AFR general officers as ARFPC alternates. Reserve component appointees may not serve while occupying a Regular Air Force position.

2.2.2.1. NGB/CF and AF/RE submits nominations for ARFPC vacancies for the air reserve component to SAF/MR through the ARFPC Full-time Support Staff in SAF/MRW.

2.2.2.2. Reserve Component alternate members are appointed for a three-year term.

2.2.2.3. The ARFPC Chair can extend membership to no more than six months as needed.

2.3. Chair and Vice Chair. Members of the Committee shall elect by majority vote a chair and vice chair from among the ARFPC primary members from the guard and reserve. ARFPC alternates are not eligible for the position of chair or vice chair.

2.3.1. The position of chair alternates between the ANG and AFR. The vice chair must be from the opposite component so that the chair and vice chair will never be from the same component. The chair serves up to two years and may be succeeded by the vice chair or any member elected by majority vote.

2.3.2. Election as Chair or Vice Chair extends an ARFPC member's appointment for up to two years.

2.3.3. Succession from Vice Chair to chair may extend appointed membership for up to two years.

2.3.4. The Chair and Vice Chair are voting members.

2.4. Non-voting Advisors.

2.4.1. The following officials serve as ARFPC non-voting advisors: the SAF/MRW Deputy Assistant Secretary; the Civil Air Patrol–USAF (CAP-USAF) Commander; the National Commander of Civil Air Patrol (CAP/CC); Headquarters Air Force Directorate of Total Force Integration (HAF/DSKI) general officers; Air Force Reserve Command Director of Manpower, Personnel, and Services (AFRC/A1); Director of Plans and Integration (AF/A1X), (NGB/A1Q), and (REP/REPX); the Chief Master Sergeant of the Air Force (CMSAF); the Chief Master Sergeant of the Space Force (CMSSF); the command chiefs of each reserve component; and Space Force members in the grade of brigadier general or above, or senior executive service (SES), from the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Personnel (SF/S1), the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Intelligence (SF/S2), the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Operations (SF/S3/4/7), the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Strategy, Plans, Programs, and Requirements (SF/S5/8), and Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Cyber and Data (SF/S6).

2.4.1.1. The CAP Advisors may permit their respective Vice commanders to attend in their absence.

2.4.1.2. The CMSAF, CMSSF, and reserve component command chiefs may each designate a senior master sergeant (E-8) or chief master sergeant (E-9) to represent them in their absence.

2.4.1.3. As the HAF/DSKI Office is comprised of a general officer from each reserve component, both may attend.

2.4.2. Other senior officers may be appointed by SAF/MR, pursuant to delegation by SecAF, or invited by the chair or vice chair of the ARFPC to attend and support ARFPC activities as non-voting advisors.

2.4.3. Due to the nature of policy matters typically under ARFPC's purview, a legal advisor from SAF/GC and AF/JA will attend any meeting of the ARFPC to include closed executive sessions and subcommittee meetings.

2.4.4. With the concurrence of the ARFPC Chair, ARFPC members may invite reserve component advisors (above the wing level) as well as key AFR and ANG functional directors to support ARFPC deliberations as subject matter experts on an as-needed basis.

2.5. Designated Representatives. Each member and alternate may designate a representative to attend ARFPC meetings on their behalf. Designated representatives do not vote.

2.5.1. Regular Air Force ARFPC members designated representatives will be the next highest ranking Regular Air Force member available within their directorate.

2.5.2. Reserve component ARFPC member's designated representatives should be the next highest ranking reserve component member available within their organization.

2.6. Designated Guests. The Chair, Executive Director, and Senior Enlisted Advisor (SEA) may invite other federal employees to the ARFPC as needed to support ARFPC activities.

2.7. ARFPC Full-Time Support Staff. SAF/MR will hire two Guard/Reserve members—one senior officer in the grade of O-6 and one senior noncommissioned officer in the grade of E-9 — from the AFR or ANG for full-time assignment in support of the ARFPC under SAF/MRW supervision, filling SAF/MRW assigned billets. The senior officer will serve as the Executive Director, and the senior noncommissioned officer will serve as the ARFPC Senior Enlisted Advisor.

2.7.1. The Executive Director position shall be held by a colonel with experience or specialized expertise in policy matters relevant to their reserve component. The Executive Director is authorized to act on behalf of the ARFPC in directing, implementing, and overseeing approved plans, programs, and policies, and is empowered to make determinations on matters that do not require formal committee action. The Executive Director may issue guidance, coordinate policy positions, and represent the ARFPC in designated forums consistent with delegated authority from the Chair.

2.7.2. The Senior Enlisted Advisor to the ARFPC shall be a chief master sergeant with experience or specialized knowledge relevant to the policy matters of their respective reserve component. The SEA will advise the ARFPC and exercise delegated authority, as directed by the Executive Director and/or Chair, to develop, coordinate, and execute policy actions in support of committee objectives. The SEA is further empowered to represent the Executive Director and/or Chair in designated policy forums and decision support processes. The SEA will direct and oversee the administrative and operational functions of the ARFPC Delegate Support Staff, ensuring effective execution of committee requirements.

2.8. ARFPC Delegate Support Staff. On behalf of the Secretary of the Air Force, SAF/MR directs each reserve component to assign a minimum of one officer and one noncommissioned officer, serving in fulltime support positions within the National Capital Region, to the ARFPC Delegate Support Staff. These personnel shall be detailed to the ARFPC as required duty and will provide administrative and operational support necessary to execute committee functions in accordance with SAF/MR established guidance. Compliance with this directive is mandatory.

2.8.1. The officer position (captain through lieutenant colonel) from each reserve component will be appointed as the NGB/CF's and AF/RE's officer delegate to the Secretary of the Air Force for the ARFPC. The appointed individual will serve a term not to exceed two years.

2.8.2. The noncommissioned officer position (staff sergeant through senior master sergeant) from each reserve component will be appointed as the NGB/CF and AF/RE enlisted delegate to the Secretary of the Air Force for the ARFPC. The appointed individual will serve a term not to exceed two years.

2.8.3. ANG and AFR leadership shall ensure that their appointed delegates to the Secretary of the Air Force are available to provide up to 45 nonconsecutive days of support annually for a period not to exceed two years. This duty shall be treated as a significant assignment in addition to the delegates' primary full-time responsibilities within the National Capital Region.

2.8.4. The Executive Director may request additional support from the AFR and ANG as needed, not to exceed five personnel from each component, including appointed delegates.

2.8.5. Support duties and responsibilities include but are not limited to: pre-conference administrative preparation, email coordination, development of conference packages, attendance tracking, on-site administrative and technical support, post-conference administration, creation of meeting minutes, consolidation of action items, strategic communications, posting updates to electronic storage, and routing requests for information to each respective component. If travel is required, it should be funded by the members' unit.

Chapter 3

ARFPC PROCEDURES

3.1. Full Conference Forum. The Full Conference Forum is convened to carry out and advance the ARFPC's statutory mission, providing the principal venue for deliberation, coordination, and execution of its mandated responsibilities.

3.1.1. The Full Conference Forum shall meet in person at least semiannually.

3.1.2. Composition shall include the 15 primary members and their alternates, the non-voting advisors, and any guests designated by the Chair, the Executive Director, or the SEA.

3.1.3. This forum shall be used to address agenda items; to receive advice and counsel from advisors and designated guests; and to provide ARFPC members with a formal, structured venue for deliberation and voting on matters submitted for their review and comment.

3.1.3.1. A quorum shall consist of the Chair or Vice Chair and no fewer than seven primary voting members. If a primary voting member is unavailable, an alternate member may serve in their place for the purpose of establishing a quorum.

3.2. Closed Executive Session. The Closed Executive Session is being held to ensure confidential, uninterrupted deliberation and to conduct formal voting on matters requiring focused attention.

3.2.1. The Closed Executive Session shall be held in person at the conclusion of each Full Conference Forum and may meet as needed between forums through authorized means, including telephone or video conferencing, email communication, or other approved electronic technologies.

3.2.2. Attendance shall be limited to the 15 ARFPC members and any duly designated alternates serving in place of absent members. The Chair may authorize the presence of designated advisors and essential support personnel when their participation is required to address matters under committee deliberation.

3.2.3. This forum shall be used to support focused discussion and decision-making on Reserve Component issues, and to conduct the election of a new Chair or Vice Chair.

3.2.4. A quorum shall consist of the Chair or Vice Chair and no fewer than seven primary voting members. If a primary voting member is unavailable, an alternate member may serve in their place for the purpose of establishing a quorum.

3.3. Subcommittee Meetings. Pursuant to statute, the ARFPC shall maintain two standing subcommittees: the subcommittee on ANG Policy and the subcommittee on AFR Policy. Each shall convene, as required, to consider and act upon policy matters that pertain exclusively to its respective Reserve Component. **(T-0)**

3.3.1. When required, subcommittees may convene in person during Full Conference Forums or meet between forums through authorized means, including telephone or video conferencing, email correspondence, or other approved electronic communication methods.

3.3.2. The Subcommittee on ANG Policy shall comprise all committee members other than those representing the AFR. The subcommittee shall be chaired by the ANG member serving as the ARFPC Chair or Vice Chair. **(T-0)**

3.3.3. The Subcommittee on AFR Policy shall comprise all committee members other than those representing the ANG. The subcommittee shall be Chaired by the AFR member serving as the ARFPC Chair or Vice Chair. **(T-0)**

3.3.4. A quorum shall consist of the subcommittee Chair and no fewer than five additional voting members when addressing policy matters affecting a single Component.

3.4. Voting.

3.4.1. Only the 15 ARFPC members appointed by SAF/MR on behalf of the SecAF, or a qualified alternate designated to vote for an unavailable primary member, shall be eligible to vote at Full Conference Forums and Closed Executive Sessions.

3.4.2. Only the 10 subcommittee members appointed by SAF/MR on behalf of the SecAF, or a qualified alternate designated to vote for an unavailable primary member, shall be eligible to vote at Subcommittee Meetings.

3.4.3. Once a quorum is established, a majority vote of the members present shall determine the findings and recommendations. Dissenting views shall be documented and conveyed in the ARFPC Chair's or subcommittee Chair's briefing to the SecAF and CSAF.

3.5. Committee Reports. At least once each year, the ARFPC Chair, Vice Chair, and one Regular Air Force member should brief the SecAF on ARFPC reviews and comments regarding any reserve component matter or mobilization policy considered. At a minimum, a written annual report will be submitted to SecAF and CSAF.

3.5.1. When deemed appropriate by the SecAF or the ARFPC Chair, any policy item impacting other military service reserve components may be forwarded by the ARFPC Chair to the Military Executive of the Reserve Forces Policy Board for review, consideration, and possible action at the Office of the Secretary of Defense level. A copy of any written annual report should be shared with the Reserve Forces Policy Board if requested by the Military Executive or desired by ARFPC leadership.

3.6. Committee Meeting Minutes. The Executive Director shall provide meeting minutes for all ARFPC members and advisors. Copies shall also be made available to Reserve Component advisors, ANG, and AFR Functional Directors through email distribution and/or posting on the ARFPC site.

3.6.1. Meeting minutes shall be submitted to the SecAF and CSAF with the annual report.

Chapter 4

MAJOR COMMAND RESERVE COMPONENT POLICY AND ADVISORY COUNCILS

4.1. Establishing Reserve Component Policy and Advisory Councils. Major command commanders should establish Reserve Component Policy and Advisory Councils to address policy matters that directly affect one or both Reserve Components assigned to their command. Reserve Component Command Advisors shall serve as the liaison between their command's Reserve Component Policy and Advisory Council and the ARFPC.

4.2. Feedback to AFRPC. MAJCOMs with ARFPC matters referred to them shall provide feedback on their proceedings and on any Reserve Component policy issues that may affect more than one command. To ensure inputs reflect validated command or enterprise level concerns—and not solely individual issues, MAJCOMs shall review and consolidate submissions prior to forwarding. All input shall be routed from command Reserve Component advisors to the ARFPC Executive Director.

4.3. Format and Function. The format and operation of MAJCOM Reserve Component Policy and Advisory Councils shall be determined by the MAJCOM commander, and operating guidance shall be issued as a MAJCOM supplement to this instruction.

4.4. ARFPC Executive Director Interaction. The ARFPC Executive Director shall serve as the focal point for communication and coordination with MAJCOM Reserve Component Policy and Advisory Councils through each command's Reserve Component Advisor. Commands that do not establish a formal council will continue to interface with the ARFPC through their assigned Advisors. The Executive Director may task advisors to provide background information or coordinate command inputs, and advisors may be asked to brief the committee on command policies affecting the Guard and Reserve.

4.5. ARFPC Full Conference Forum. MAJCOM Reserve Component Advisors, including NAF Reserve Component Advisors within a command, may be invited to participate in an ARFPC Full Conference Forum.

Chapter 5

HEADQUARTERS AIR FORCE RESERVE COMPONENT ADVISORS AND ANG AND AFR FUNCTIONAL DIRECTORS

5.1. Link Between the ARFPC and Ongoing Air Force Policy Development. Headquarters Air Force Reserve Component Advisors and ANG and AFR Functional Directors serve as a critical link between the ARFPC and ongoing Air Force policy development. When issues arise requiring background information or follow-up with DAF policy implications, these officers—coordinating with NGB/CF and AF/RE—interpret and provide guidance on policies affecting the reserve component and recommend approaches for integrating proposed policies across the Total Force.

5.2. ARFPC Executive Director Interaction. When acting on behalf of the ARFPC Chair or Vice Chair, the Executive Director is authorized to task HAF Reserve Component Advisors and ANG/AFR Functional Directors to provide background information, conduct analysis, or coordinate input from their respective functional communities. Reserve Component Advisors may also be directed to brief the committee on policies, programs, or issues affecting the Guard and Reserve.

5.3. ARFPC Full Conference Forum. HAF Reserve Component Advisors and ANG/AFR Functional Directors may be invited to participate in an ARFPC Full Conference Forum.

BRIAN L. SCARLETT
Principal Deputy Assistant Secretary
of the Air Force for Manpower
and Reserve Affairs

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

10 U.S.C. § 10305, *Air Force Reserve Forces Policy Committee*

HAFMD 1- 1, *Headquarters Department of the Air Force (HQ DAF)*, 8 April 2026

HAFMD 1-24, *Assistant Secretary of the Air Force (Manpower and Reserve Affairs)*, 28 January 2019

DAFPD 36-26, *Total Force Development and Management*, 18 January 2024

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020

DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, 18 October 2023

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AFR—Air Force Reserve

ANG—Air National Guard

ARFPC—Air Reserve Forces Policy Committee

CMSAF—Chief Master Sergeant of the Air Force

CMSSF—Chief Master Sergeant of the Space Force

CSAF—Chief of Staff of the Air Force

ISR—Intelligence, Surveillance and Reconnaissance

SecAF—Secretary of the Air Force

TFI—Total Force Integration

Office Symbols

AF/A1P—Director of Military Force Management Policy

AF/A1X—Director of Plans and Integration

AF/A2—Director of ISR Operations

AF/A34—Director of Training and Readiness

AF/A4L—Director of Logistics

AF/A4S—Director of Security Forces

AF/A5S—Director of Strategy, Concepts, and Assessments

AF/A8X—Director of Strategic Plans

AF/JA—The Judge Advocate General

AF/RE—Chief of Air Force Reserve

AF/REP—Director of Personnel

AFRC/A1—Air Force Reserve Command Director of Manpower, Personnel, and Services

CAP/CC—National Commander of Civil Air Patrol

CAP-USAF—Civil Air Patrol – United States Air Force

HAF/DSKI—Headquarters Air Force, Directorate of Total Force Integration

NGB/A1—Director of Force Management Policy

NGB/CF—Director of the Air National Guard

SAF/GC—Air Force General Counsel

SAF/MR—Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Manpower and Reserve Affairs

SAF/MRW—Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Warfighter Force Management and Readiness

SF/S1—Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Personnel

SF/S2—Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Intelligence

SF/S3/4/7—Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Operations

SF/S5/8—Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Strategy, Plans, Programs, and Requirements

SF/S6—Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Cyber and Data